In the first demo, authorization functions as a reactive control. The agent proposes actions, the policy system evaluates them, and the agent then adapts based on the results.

In the second demo, authorization serves as a source of guidance. By querying policy constraints during planning, the agent can develop strategies that stay within defined boundaries, reducing trial-and-error behavior.

In the third demo, authorization governs collaboration. Delegation is represented as structured data, and policies ensure that subagents operate only within the authority explicitly granted to them.

Across all three examples, the same architectural pattern holds. Authorization decisions are made by a policy engine, informed by structured inputs, and enforced consistently at runtime. What changes is how those decisions are applied: first as a gate, then as a guide, and finally as a mechanism for safely distributing authority.

These patterns illustrate the central idea of chapter 18: in agentic systems, authorization is not just about controlling access. It becomes integral to how agents plan, act, and work together within clearly defined and enforceable boundaries.